

Fishing Log — User Guide

Smith Mountain Lake · A Private Fishing Log for Our Crew

Version 2.1 · Created by John Parrent

Fishing Log is a free web app for logging your Smith Mountain Lake striper trips — what you caught, where, and under what conditions. Over time it builds YOUR playbook: which water temps, baits, moon phases, and spots actually produce. It runs in any web browser on your computer or phone. There is nothing to install.

Web address: <https://fishing-log-fmvre8u5mrqhfsgsfhxroj.streamlit.app>

1. Signing in

Open the web address above and click **Sign in with Google**. You'll use your regular Google account — there is no separate password to remember. Your trips are private to your email address: nobody else in the club can see your data, and you can't see theirs.

First-time heads-up: most people go straight through, but Google MAY show a one-time screen that says "Google hasn't verified this app." If you see it, click **Advanced**, then **Go to Fishing Log**, then **Continue**. Google shows that notice only because our app hasn't gone through their formal (paid) verification process. The app itself is private, and you'll never see the screen again.

If sign-in tells you that you don't have access yet, your email hasn't been added to the approved list — just ask John Parrent (Striper Club Member) to add you.

Want to look around first?

Click **Try the Demo** on the sign-in page. You'll get a read-only tour with 15 sample trips already loaded so you can click through every page. Nothing you do in the demo can break anything.

2. Logging a trip (Log a Session)

This is the page you'll use most. Fill it out right at the dock — it takes about a minute.

Set your spot(s) on the map

- Click the map to drop your starting pin. Click again to add each spot along your troll.
- The map opens centered on the water you fished **last trip** — handy if you pound the same spots.
- Under the map, enter how many fish you caught at each spot (0 = none). Spots with fish show a fish icon on the map, with an ×N badge when you caught several there.
- Use the **Last** button to undo the most recent pin or **Clear** to start over.

Tracking your trolling route

This is one of the coolest features. Don't stop at one pin — click the map again at each point along your troll. Later, when you open that trip in Browse & Search, you'll see your whole route drawn out: the pins are numbered in the order you dropped them, a line with arrows shows the direction you trolled, and a fish icon marks every spot where you entered a fish count.

Not trolling? Multiple pins still work great — drop one on each hole you fished that day.

Good to know: the big Map page shows ONE pin per trip, and it uses your FIRST pin. So make your first click the spot that best represents the trip — usually where you started — then add the rest of the route after it.

Fill in the details

- Date, start/end time (dropdowns, 15-minute steps — hours fished computes automatically).
- Weather, air and water temperature, number of anglers.
- Bait/lure: pick one you've used before from the list, or type a new one.
- Style: Downlines, Jigging, Light Lines, Planer Boards, Topwater, Trolling, or Umbrella Rig.
- Notes: anything worth remembering — bait ball at 25 ft, birds working the point, etc.

Enter your fish

In the **Fish caught** table, pick a species, then enter length, depth, and weight. Caught more than one? Click the blank row at the bottom of the table and it becomes a new fish — the table grows one row at a time as you need it. Check **Kept?** for harvested fish (leave unchecked for released). Got skunked? Just leave the table alone — rows without a species are ignored. When you hit Save, the confirmation shows your total fish count so you can double-check the tally.

Only the species is required — a fish with just a species still counts in every catch stat (totals, success rate, fish per hour). Length, depth, and weight are optional: leave any of them blank with no issue. The trade-off is simple — whatever you enter feeds your Analytics, and whatever you skip just sits out those charts. Measure your fish and the Sizes and Personal Bests pages come alive.

The small checkbox on the far LEFT of each row is only for deleting rows: check it and a trash can appears at the top of the table. You don't need it for normal entry.

Hit **Save session** and you're done. A confirmation appears below the form along with the DWR report card (next section).

3. Filing your DWR striper report

Virginia DWR asks striper anglers to report each outing. The app does the paperwork for you: after you save a trip, a report card appears with your numbers already totaled.

- **Step 1 — Open pre-filled DWR report:** opens the official Google Form with your date, hours, anglers, and harvested/released counts and sizes already filled in. Review it and hit Submit.
- **Step 2 — Mark as filed to DWR:** check this box after you submit so the app knows it's done.

Once you check Step 2, that report is a done deal — the card switches to "Filed on (date)" and the buttons go away so nobody can accidentally double-file. If you later edit a filed trip, the app reminds you that the state already has its copy. Checked the box by mistake? There's an **Unmark** button inside

the trip's edit form.

The Dashboard shows a reminder listing any trips you haven't filed yet.

4. Reviewing trips (Browse & Search)

- Filter by date range, location, or species at the top of the page.
- Each trip shows as a card — click **View details** to open the full record.
- The detail view shows everything: conditions, the fish table, your trolling route on a map, and the DWR report status.
- **Edit this session** sits right at the top of the detail — expand it to fix anything.
- **Delete this session** is at the very bottom, on purpose — it can't be undone.

5. Calendar

- A month grid of your season: **green** days = caught fish, **gray** days = skunked, white = no trip.
- Each trip day shows the fish count and location; the moon phase icon appears in the corner.
- Navigate with Prev / Next, jump to **Today**, or hit **Year ago** to compare against last season.
- Below the grid, every trip that month is listed — click **View** → to read the full detail without leaving the page.

6. Analytics

This is where the log pays off. Pick a year and browse the tabs:

Analytics runs on whatever you've entered — a fish logged without a weight still counts as a fish everywhere; it just won't appear in the size and weight charts. The more detail you log, the more these pages can tell you.

- **Monthly:** trips, fish, and success rate by month.
- **Sizes:** how your fish measure up over the season.
- **Personal Bests:** your longest and heaviest fish, by species, with dates.
- **What's Working:** your most productive water temps, weather, baits, styles, and times — ranked by fish per hour.

7. Map

- Every trip's spot on one map, color-coded by how the day went: Skunked (0), Good (1–3), Great (4–6), Blowout (7+).
- Click a pin for the trip's date, conditions, bait, and catch.
- Turn on the **catch hotspots** checkbox for a heat map of everywhere you've actually caught fish.
- Each trip appears as one pin — specifically the **FIRST** pin you dropped when logging it (your full trolling route lives in the trip's detail under Browse & Search).

- The same date/location/species filters apply, and there's a full-screen toggle.

8. Backup & Export

The **Backup & Export** page downloads a single ZIP with EVERYTHING: your trips, every fish (with kept/released), and your map spots and routes — plus a backup.json file the app can restore from. Grab one every month or so and stash it somewhere safe.

- **Download full backup (ZIP)** — the one button that backs up everything.
- **Restore from backup** — upload a backup ZIP and the app loads those trips back into your account. Trips you already have are skipped automatically.
- Prefer spreadsheets? The individual Sessions and Fish CSVs are still there under "Individual CSVs" — handy for Excel, but the ZIP is the real backup.

9. Using it on your phone

The app works in your phone's browser and is tuned for smaller screens — bigger buttons, a compact calendar, and a simpler layout.

- Tap the teal **Menu** button (top-left) to open the page list; it closes itself after you pick a page. When the menu is open, **Hide menu** tucks it away.
- **Make it feel like a real app:** in Safari or Chrome, tap Share → **Add to Home Screen**. You get a Fishing Log icon that opens full-screen, no address bar.
- The computer is still the best place for map-heavy work like setting trolling routes; the phone is great for logging a trip at the dock and checking your log anywhere.

10. Quick answers

Is my data private?

Trips are tied to your email, and the app only ever shows you your own log — no other member can see it. (As with any shared cloud database, John, as the administrator, can access the database when maintaining the app.)

I got skunked. Do I still log it?

Absolutely — skunked trips are data too, and the DWR wants those reports just as much. Save the session with the fish table left empty.

I made a mistake on a trip.

Browse & Search → open the trip → Edit this session (top of the detail). Fix it and Save changes.

Can I lose my data?

It lives in a cloud database, not on your phone. For belt-and-suspenders, download a full backup ZIP now and then — if anything ever goes wrong, the Restore button puts it all back.

Something looks broken.

Note what page you were on and what you clicked, then tell John Parrent. The 'build' number at the bottom of the menu helps troubleshooting.

Have an idea to make it better?

Tell John Parrent! The app is homegrown and always improving — member suggestions are where the best features come from.

Tight lines!